provoked the United States, the world's leading power, to begin thinking, planning, and building the tools and capabilities to contend with the threat in all aspects—how to defend against it by developing new technologies and combat doctrines, how to attack it using new weapons, how to deal with the legal and moral challenges to Western democracies, and more. The US government understood the depth and dimensions of the threat and established the Department of Homeland Security (DHS) to help cope with it. This was the largest organizational change to be made in the US government since the end of World War II. However, building an overarching strategy and implementing it, both within the security forces and in public consciousness, requires a process that can take years. European countries such as France and Belgium truly understood the extent of the threat only fifteen years after the United States, after they suffered terrible blows by radical Islamic terrorism in their capital cities. Even an optimistic forecast suggests that it will be quite a few more years before western Europe is properly equipped to contend with the threat.

Israel was the first country that was forced to deal with radical Islamic terrorism. It preceded the Western countries in learning about the threat and building up the capabilities to deal with it, and it shared its experience and insights with its allies around the world. The problem with such insights is that they are not properly absorbed until these allies experience the threat for themselves. And this is natural and predictable, especially if we remind ourselves that the 9/11 attacks were the first assault by a foreign enemy on American territory since Pearl Harbor, sixty years earlier!

Below are some of the key insights that the State of Israel, through the IDF, the Shin Bet, the Mossad, and the police, has shared with its friends around the world since the early 1980s. Israel shared its experiences on the basis of the working assumption that the only way to deal with global terrorism effectively is through international cooperation, in which each member contributes its comparative advantage to the joint effort, thereby creating a force multiplier. We called on the world to learn from our experience and to legitimize aspects of the strategy we developed over years of trial and error.

This strategy is based on the following principles:

- In the context of an ongoing violent conflict in which the enemy is looking for every opportunity and any soft underbelly to attack, the